

Windows. And even if you did have the official software installed, IranView is still faster. Case in point would be Photoshop and CAD drawings. If you were to open a .PSD file, then your system will first open Photoshop which on its own takes anywhere from 4-30 seconds to load and then the .PSD file would take its own sweet time to open based on how many layers and how large the file is. IrfanView, on the other hand, can usually open the same file in under 2 seconds.

While the base software is more than capable of reading a lot of multimedia file formats, you can extend these features and add more by means of the separately downloadable IrfanView Plugins file. Both 32-bit and 64-bit versions of the plugins have the same set of features with the obvious distinction being that the 64-bit version allows you to open way larger files owing to the greater addressable memory that 64-bit software can access. The entire installer package is about 30 MBs.

If you haven't used IrfanView in the past, there are a few eccentricities that you will have to get used to. The first of which is that IrfanView doesn't save the state of the file when you make changes. Say, you add a Sharpness filter and change the colour tone of an image. When you try to quit any software after making such changes, you will be prompted with a dialog box asking you to save or discard changes made to the file. If you do the same set of actions in IrfanView, it simply quits without giving you the dialog prompt. Moreover, tapping the left or right arrow keys will switch to the next image in the folder and you'll lose whatever changes you have made to the existing image. So you have to be very careful when using IrfanView for making edits. The changes aren't saved unless you explicitly use the Save function from the menu. These are just some of the eccentricities of IrfanView. Let's take a look at all the other features that IrfanView is good for.

Common use cases

Opening a megatonne of image file formats

The most obvious feature that you'd want to use IrfanView for is as your default image viewer. It's quicker than everything else, including the default Windows Photos app. As usual, the left and right arrow keys are used to switch to the previous or next image in the directory and the + and - keys are used for changing the zoom levels.

Converting images to a megatonne of image file formats

As with the simple task of opening a multitude of image file formats, Irfan-